

IS RUNNING FOR STATE OFFICE RIGHT FOR ME?

RHODE ISLAND EDITION

The opportunities provided to state officers are tremendous, and many state officer alumni consider their time as an officer as a pivotal experience in their life. Along with the opportunities and benefits of being an officer comes many important responsibilities. Take the opportunity to carefully consider your decision to run for state office and what it requires.

The average state officer will spend 3-5 hours a week, working on state officer projects and responsibilities. Additional time may be required while planning and finalizing events. It is important to realize that although academics remain the number one priority, you will not be able to fall behind in your responsibilities as an FBLA State officer. You are required to participate in the team decision making process, perform your assigned tasks, and attend all required conferences and events.

If you are elected, you are required to attend conferences, officer meetings, and FBLA events throughout the year. These events will occur either in person or virtually. You are not allowed to leave early, arrive late, or miss any of these events (except in the case of an extreme emergency). State officers have had to miss big games, dances, trips, etc., because these activities conflicted with state officer responsibilities. The expectation is that your state officer responsibilities and commitments take priority, after your academics.

Please carefully review the documents and information in this guide to ensure you fully understand what is expected/required of you as a state officer if you are elected.

If you are willing to make this commitment, and you are the type of person that has the drive to succeed and the encouragement and dedication to get the job done, an FBLA office is definitely for you. If you are unsure, you may want to speak with your adviser to see if running for a state officer is the right decision. If you decide to run for office, be assured that holding state office will be one of the most memorable experiences of your life, and one of the most effective career preparation experiences you can have while in high school.

JOB DESCRIPTIONS - All Officers

1. Attend all State Officer meetings from start to finish, including meetings conducted via conference call.
2. Plan the Program of Work as a team, and work to achieve the goals and objectives set forth in it.
3. Attend all State Officer meetings as outlined below
 - a. State Officer Training and Program of Work Meeting
 - b. National Leadership Conference—(very strongly encouraged, some financial support provided by State)
 - c. State Officer Meetings
 - d. State Conference Planning Meetings—Dates TBD
 - e. State Leadership Conference—October TBD
 - f. The President is required to attend the RI FBLA meetings with partners as scheduled.
 - g. Other activities as determined by State Officer Training Program of Work
4. Contribute social media content for Instagram, LinkedIn, X (Twitter), Facebook and other outlets.
5. Communicate with the President, State Adviser, and the State Board on a regular basis. Respond in a timely manner to all emails/voicemails (within 24 hours). Get all official correspondence approved by the State Advisor before sending to advisors, business leaders, potential sponsors, board members, etc.
6. Read State Officer Handbook and submit required forms by application deadline given when distributed and abide by policies and procedures outlined in the handbook (Signatures Below - Page 6 & 8). **DEADLINE FOR APPLICATION~ February 26, 2026 by 5PM.**
7. Complete assignments listed in the Program of Work (to be developed with a team once elected) as well as any additional state officer assignments received during the year.
8. Submit assignments on time and ensure that all state officer assignments submitted represent your very best work.
9. Be an exemplary member of Rhode Island FBLA at all times by abiding by the Code of Conduct, Dress Code, and officer standards outlined in the State Officer Handbook.
10. Each officer submits a monthly report (5th of the month report) about local, and state FBLA activities participated in (one per month and submitted no later than the fifth of each month).
11. Keep a notebook of all activities during term in office.
12. Prepare transition materials to be shared with your successor at the close of your term in office.
13. Conduct chapter visits and work with assigned chapters to assist with growth and development of the FBLA program.
14. Participate actively and fully as a local chapter member. It is not recommended that state officers also serve as local chapter officers, but they may with approval from the local chapter adviser. State Officers are also chapter members and accountable to their chapter adviser for fulfillment of their chapter duties, abiding by chapter policies, and participating fully in chapter activities. State Officers **MUST** work closely with their chapter adviser on all State Officer assignments and keep their chapter adviser informed of their State Officer activities, assignments, upcoming meetings, and provide their local adviser with a copy of their fifth of the month report at the same time the report is submitted to the State Officer Adviser.

PURPOSE

Becoming a Rhode Island FBLA State Officer requires a commitment on the part of all parties concerned. In order to make that commitment, each party must understand their responsibility to this leadership training experience. In order for a candidate to be eligible for office, all parties indicated must sign this agreement. State officer candidates should understand that, if elected, attendance at all state officer meetings and activities is mandatory and that failure to attend any of these meetings will result in their removal from office, with the exception of emergencies/unsafe traveling conditions. They should also understand that they may be removed from office if in the opinion of the State Management Team they fail to comply with State Officer responsibilities/assignments or participate in activities/conduct, which would reflect negatively on Rhode Island FBLA or the State Officer Team.

IF ELECTED, THE CANDIDATE AGREES TO (Please Initial)

_____ Perform to the best of his/her ability the duties of the elected office. (Review the State Officer Job Description section of this packet for a partial listing.)

_____ Maintain a GPA of 2.5 or better based on a 4.0 scale during their term of office and be willing to provide supporting documentation when requested by State Staff.

_____ Fully participate in the development and execution of a state Program of Work (goals and objectives). All State Officers will be required to accept assignments for project work, chapter visitations, etc. State Officers are required to submit a written report of activities each month.

_____ Attend and participate in all meetings (including, but not limited to, state officer meetings, state officer trainings, and state conferences)

_____ Attest that: "I fully understand the responsibilities and obligations of the position I seek; and, if elected, will carry them out to the very best of my ability. I further understand that **if, in the opinion of the majority of the State Board, and State Officer Adviser. If I fail to fulfill my responsibilities and obligations of office, and/or I violate the Rhode Island FBLA Code of Conduct, I can be removed from office.** Should I fail to complete the duties of my office, I will be liable to return to FBLA the amount expended for my participation during my term in office."

_____ Agree to authorize Rhode Island FBLA to use the student's name and likeness (including photographs, video footage, silhouettes, and audio clips) in Rhode Island FBLA's publications, productions, and their web site for informational, promotional, and other related purposes.

_____ Participate in ALL activities scheduled by the State Management Team of the Rhode Island State Chapter of FBLA. Required scheduled activities include the following:

REQUIRED EVENTS (Dates to be determined)

- Rhode Island CTSO State Officer Leadership Training (Dates to be determined)
- June National Leadership Conference Strongly Encouraged, some financial support may be provided by RI FBLA pending available funds. (Recommended)
- October- RI FBLA State Fall Leadership Conference (JWU Harborside Campus)

- February - RI FBLA State Leadership Breakfast (JWU Harborside Campus)
- March - RI FBLA State Leadership Conference & RI FBLA Awards Ceremony (JWU Providence Campus)

ADDITIONAL EVENTS

- All State Officers are required to attend virtual team meetings and in-person monthly meetings
- Other events and activities may be determined in the State Officer Program of Work

Please Note:

Every effort is made to schedule so that conflicts do not occur. However, often the dates that are chosen conflict with other local school and personal activities such as proms or playoff games. If you choose to be a State Officer, you will be required to attend all of the scheduled State Officer activities no matter what other conflicts arise. If you are not willing to put FBLA activities ahead of local and personal activities (not including school, family, and religious obligations), please do not apply to be a State Officer.

Attention Advisers, Parents, School Officials, and Employers:

The preceding Rhode Island FBLA schedule of required meetings will result in the student missing over 3-5 school days plus additional days of weekend and vacation time. All expenses for required activities will be reimbursed as the budget permits by the state chapter. Non-required activities may be partially reimbursed upon approval of the State Adviser and State Chair.

THE PARENTS/GUARDIANS AND EMPLOYER AGREE TO:

(Please Initial ALL Items)

_____ Permit the candidate to participate in all scheduled Rhode Island Chapter of FBLA activities, State Officer meetings, chapter visits, and other official officer duties (please read the candidate agreement above).

_____ Encourage the candidate to take full benefit of the leadership development experience.

_____ Fully support the student in his or her pursuit of scholastic achievement.

_____ Agree to authorize Rhode Island FBLA to use the student's name and likeness (including photographs, video footage, silhouettes, and audio clips) in Rhode Island FBLA's publications, productions, and their web site for informational, promotional, and other related purposes.

_____ If the student is elected, permit, and in the case of parents, authorize the student to visit Rhode Island schools and participate in Rhode Island FBLA chapter activities for the purpose of conducting official FBLA State Officer business.

_____ Attend any scheduled Rhode Island FBLA activities when Parents/Guardians so desire.

_____ **(Parents/Guardians)** Understand that it is possible for their student to be removed from office at any time if the student violates the provisions of the State Officer Handbook or acts or conducts themselves in any way that is harmful/detrimental to the State Officer Program or Rhode Island FBLA (each student will receive a copy of this State Officer Handbook after they are elected to office and parents/guardians will be asked to sign a document(s) from the Handbook indicating that they have read and agree to abide by the provisions of the State Officer Handbook).

_____ **(Parents/Guardians)** Agree to be responsible for providing/coordinating safe transportation of their officer to and from all State Officer meetings, state conferences, and state sponsored events which their officer is required to attend. (Permission travel forms are required and must be signed by the parent/guardian for each meeting, conference, and event). Required meetings, conferences, and events will be held in various locations throughout the State of Rhode Island during the year so significant travel will be required.

THE ADVISER AND SCHOOL OFFICIALS AGREE TO:

(Please Initial ALL Items)

_____ Recommend the student as one who is able to fully participate as a State Officer (e.g., there are no academic restrictions that would prevent them from being able to fulfill their officer duties like restrictions on participation in extracurricular activities, travel, etc.).

_____ Ensure the candidate's membership dues are paid by October 20th (Please read the candidate agreement on the previous page).

_____ Ensure the candidate's attendance at all Rhode Island FBLA activities (Please read the candidate agreement on the previous page).

_____ Read the Candidate Contract and Code of Conduct and discuss its implications with the student.

_____ Actively support and advise the officer during the performance of their official duties.

_____ Permit the candidate to visit Rhode Island schools and participate in FBLA chapter activities for the purpose of conducting official FBLA State Officer business.

_____ Certify that the candidate has earned a GPA of 2.5 (4.0 base) or better for the term preceding the election and that officer maintains this during their term of office.

CANDIDATE CONTRACT SIGNED

Note: This Candidate Agreement is four (4) pages in length.

Candidate Name	_____	Date: _____
Chapter Adviser Signature	_____	Date: _____
Parent Signature	_____	Date: _____
High School Principal	_____	Date: _____
High School Guidance Counselor	_____	Date: _____
Fall Athletic Coach	_____	Date: _____
Winter Athletic Coach	_____	Date: _____
Spring Athletic Coach	_____	Date: _____
Summer Athletic Coach	_____	Date: _____
Employer(s)	_____	Date: _____
Employer(s)	_____	Date: _____

Note: If the candidate changes schools, jobs, and/or sports at any time during their state officer year and signatures above are not complete and current; this document must be signed again and resent to Rhode Island FBLA.

CODE OF CONDUCT AGREEMENT

PRINT & SUBMIT THIS FORM.

Please review all points expectations and sign agreement form below.

This Code of Conduct is applicable throughout the officer's term of office for all FBLA events, activities, meetings, and conferences.

FBLA, as an integral part of the Business Education programs in Rhode Island, offers training to students with career objectives in business and office occupations. Because individual conduct and appearance is a phase of this training, it becomes the responsibility of all delegates to conduct themselves in a proper, businesslike manner at all times from the time they leave home until they return home.

Attendance at any FBLA sponsored conference or activity is a special privilege. Knowing that any organization is judged largely by the behavior of its individual participants, the following Code of Conduct is to be subscribed to by members, guests, and advisers who attend any FBLA conference or sponsored activity:

- All chapter members attending the FBLA Leadership Conferences are required to attend all sessions of the conferences, unless previously arranged by chapter advisers according to state policy.
- All persons shall behave in a courteous and respectful manner, refraining from language and actions that might bring discredit upon themselves, their school, their home, their friends, the conference, or upon the FBLA organization.
- Attendants are guests using the facilities; special care should be taken to not deface or destroy any property. Individuals who inflict damage to the building will be held liable for any costs incurred for repair.
- Dress regulations established for the conference shall be business attire. Conservative sportswear will be appropriate in specifically designed situations. Delegates shall abide by the dress code established by the Rhode Island and National Board of Directors for all state functions. Delegates not adhering to the dress code shall not be admitted to the functions listed above. Read conference packets for specific instructions. • No alcoholic beverages, illegal drugs, vaping, or tobacco in any form shall be possessed or used at any time or under any circumstances on public or private properties. Use or possession of such substances may subject the student delegate to criminal prosecution.
- School district policy shall be in effect for adviser/adult ratio during all Rhode Island FBLA activities. If a district does not have a policy, a ratio of 10 students to 1 adviser/adult will be in effect.
- Identification badges are to be worn at all times throughout the conference. For security reasons, delegates should not wear name badges while away from the conference facilities and functions.
- Student delegates are not permitted to leave conference facilities without the approval of their adviser.
- Advisers are responsible for taking all reasonable precautions to ensure the safety of their student delegates at all FBLA functions and must be readily available in case of an emergency. • Delegates shall respect and abide by the authority vested in the Rhode Island Board of Trustees.
- No adviser should accept responsibility for a student delegate from another school without a written agreement between the administrations of the two schools. That agreement should be attached to the registration forms. No student delegates will be accepted without an adviser listed or a written agreement attached.
- Adult student delegates shall abide by the rules and regulations for a minor student delegate.
- Serious misconduct shall be reported to the adviser, principal, parents, and, if necessary, the proper authorities. Any further disciplinary action will be determined by board action and may result in up to one calendar year of ineligibility.
- Advisers are responsible for the supervision of conduct. Student delegates who disregard the Code of Conduct will be subject to disciplinary action and may be sent home at their own expense and will be disqualified from competitive awards or withdrawn from office, if applicable. Parents and/or school district officials will be notified.
- It is agreed that, upon violation of the Code of Conduct, the violators may be asked to vacate their hotel rooms and withdraw from the conference activities by the proper FBLA authorities.
- Advisers are responsible for the supervision of delegate conduct. The delegate's adviser and Rhode Island FBLA Executive Director shall first discuss serious Rhode Island FBLA Code of

Conduct violations. Delegate's parents, school principal, and, if necessary, the proper authorities will then be notified.

- Student delegates who are guilty of misconduct will be subject to disciplinary action; a delegate may be:
 - 1) asked to vacate his/her hotel room immediately and sent home independently from other chapter delegation members resulting in additional travel expenses to the delegate and the delegate's parents;
 - 2) disqualified from competitive awards; and
 - 3) if applicable, removed from office. Anyone being in the willful companionship of another person violating the FBLA Code of Conduct will also be subject to disciplinary action.
- Upon a violation occurring, parents/guardians will be notified that their child is being sent home. It is understood that parents will be available to pick up their child and/or willing to pay additional travel expenses incurred by their child from the hotel to the bus station and/or airport (example: taxi), extra bus fare and/or airfare required to travel home, and transportation charges from the bus station and/or airport terminal to their home. Parents, if necessary, will be liable for adviser expenditures resulting from accompanying their child to his/her departure location. Any further disciplinary action will be determined by the Rhode Island FBLA Board of Advisers and may result in up to one calendar year of ineligibility.

Student Name _____

Student Signature _____

Date: _____

Parent/Guardian Name _____

Parent/Guardian Signature _____

Date: _____

1st Parent/Guardian Phone Number (____)____-____

2nd Parent/Guardian Phone Number (____)____-____

Local Adviser Name: _____

Local Adviser Signature: _____